

Business Growth Checklist

A practical checklist to pressure-test whether your business is set up to grow sustainably — across strategy, operations, people, and systems.

Strategy & Direction

- ☐ **1. Clear growth thesis**
You can state, in one sentence, where growth will come from next (new customers, new markets, new products, or deeper accounts) — and why.
- ☐ **2. Defined target customer**
Your best-fit customer is written down and used to qualify leads, not just described loosely as “anyone who'll buy.”
- ☐ **3. Quarterly priorities set**
The business has 3–5 written priorities for the quarter that everyone on the leadership team can name.

Operations & Systems

- ☐ **4. Core processes documented**
Your top 5 recurring processes (sales, delivery, onboarding, support, fulfillment) exist as written SOPs, not tribal knowledge.
- ☐ **5. Bottleneck identified**
You know the single constraint currently limiting growth — capacity, cash, leads, or delivery — and it's not a guess.
- ☐ **6. Tooling matches scale**
The systems you use today (spreadsheets, CRM, accounting) can handle 2x your current volume without breaking.

People & Capability

- ☐ **7. Roles are structured**
Every team member's core responsibilities are defined well enough that a new hire could read them and understand the job.
- ☐ **8. Decisions don't bottleneck at the top**
At least some day-to-day decisions can be made without the founder/owner in the room.
- ☐ **9. Hiring plan exists**
You know which role you'd hire next if growth accelerated, and roughly when.

Financial Readiness

- ☐ **10. Unit economics are known**
You can state your cost to acquire a customer and the margin per sale or per engagement.
- ☐ **11. Cash runway is tracked**
You know how many months of runway you have and what would extend or shorten it.
- ☐ **12. Growth is funded, not just wished for**
You have a realistic view of what the next stage of growth will cost — in cash, time, or people — before you commit to it.

How to use this: Be honest, not aspirational. Anywhere you leave a box unchecked is a candidate for your next quarter's priorities — not everything at once.